

What followed was a lot of research. I dug up the issue the August issue of Digit, which had the test and re-read it. Then I carefully looked at my options in terms of what was available. I wanted a high-end, 8-bit panel based on either IPS or PVA technology. The reason is simple – viewing angles (necessary while watching movies), and colour and contrast. Once you have seen what a good LCD monitor has to offer in terms of overall display quality, you will never want to use a cheaper TN panel-based display. Obviously higher end panels are costly to manufacture and this adds to the cost of the product. I shortlisted a number of products I would consider. Usually, high-end monitors have additional connects like Component, HDMI and possibly DisplayPort – useful for compatibility and usage over a wide range of products, for example, a Blu-ray player, or an HTPC or even a console – something to consider if you have any of these. For PC users, DVI connectivity is a must, do not opt for a monitor that only has D-Sub i.e. analogue connects.



An extended weekend saw me with enough time for a sojourn to Lamington Road. I caught a bus and one sweaty hour later, just before noon was there. Now the best way to buy an LCD monitor is to check the model numbers online and jot them down. You don't want to be arguing with a shopkeeper about the validity of a model number; just as sure as you don't want to be picking a monitor based solely on what each vendor has in his shop. This is one category where most shopkeepers do not stock more than one or two pieces and usually they're the bare essential ones. It is the distributors who stock different models in bulk and any shop can get you nearly any model from any brand. A couple of few exceptions to the brands would be Dell and HP – these brands do have models available in the market, but since especially Dell deals directly with end users, most vendors who